

City of Abbotsford
Sport Field & Sport Court Strategy

SUMMARY OVERVIEW

February 2026



About the Strategy

The City of Abbotsford's new Sport Field & Sport Court Strategy will help guide how the City will invest in and provide outdoor sport facilities over the next 20+ years.



A draft of the Strategy has been developed and the City is looking to get feedback from the public and groups. This feedback will be used to finalize the Strategy and develop an implementation plan to advance the draft actions.

This summary document provides an overview of the draft Strategy. The full draft Strategy and background reports can be found here: (<https://letstalkabbotsford.ca/sport-field-court-strategy>)

Outdoor Sport Facilities Included in this Strategy:



Sport fields



Ball diamonds



Games courts



Pickleball courts



Tennis courts



Sand volleyball courts



Skate parks



Bike parks



Disc golf courses



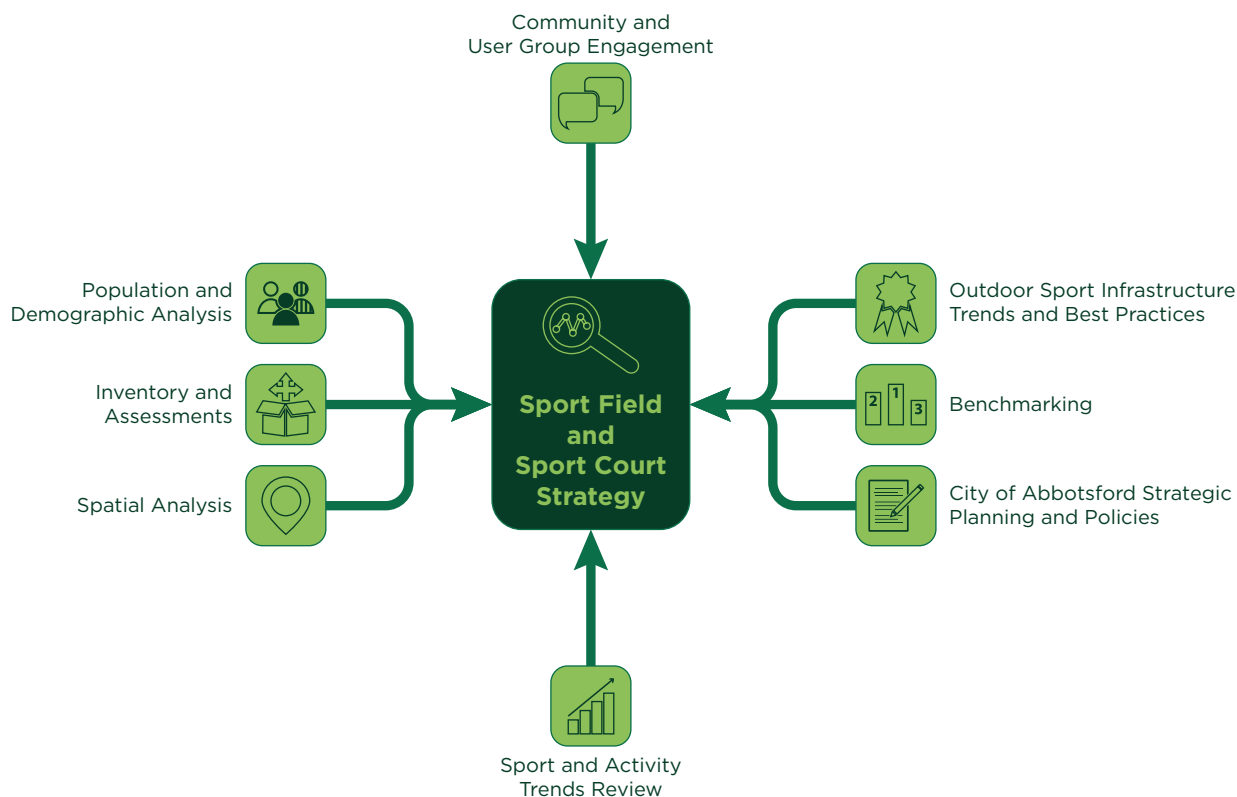
Lawn bowling



Horseshoes

Draft Strategy Inputs – How did we learn about sport fields and courts in Abbotsford?

Several forms of research and engagement were used to explore key topics related to outdoor amenities in Abbotsford. Through the research and engagement, the project team was able to better understand current strengths, gaps, future needs, and opportunities to optimize the inventory.



Community Input into the Draft Strategy



809 responses provided to a Community Survey.



22 user groups provided feedback through participation in a Discussion Session and/or User Group Survey.



65 comments were provided through a Virtual Mapping tool.

Key findings from the research and engagement are contained in two background reports – the Engagement Summary Report and the Research & Analysis Summary Report. The link on the previous page can be used to access these reports through the project page.

Draft Strategic Goals

5 Draft Strategic Goals have been developed to establish overall focus areas or “goalposts” for outdoor sport amenity management and investment in the city.



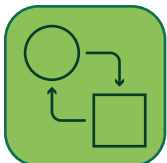
Goal#1: Align outdoor sport amenity provision with best practice.



Goal #2: Renew existing outdoor sport amenities in a targeted and strategic manner.



Goal #3: Grow the inventory to meet anticipated future growth.



Goal #4: Ensure outdoor sport facilities and amenities balance meeting the unique needs of users with flexibility and adaptability.



Goal #5: Continue to place a priority on user engagement and communications.

Draft Actions

The Draft Strategy includes 15 Draft Actions organized by four categories of outdoor amenities. The Draft Actions reflect recommended priorities and focus areas for the City's future investment and resource allocation into outdoor sport amenities. The Draft Actions are summarized as follows. **Refer to the Draft Strategy for additional information and detail on each Draft Action.*

Draft Actions for the Management of Outdoor Sport Amenities

- A. Implement a new classification system for sport fields and diamonds.
- B. Continue to work towards aligning booked use of outdoor sport amenities with the City's Allocations Policy Framework.
- C. Undertake a review of operational and maintenance resourcing and practices.
- D. Invest in better understanding casual and spontaneous use of outdoor sport assets.

Summary of Draft Actions for Field and Diamond Sports

- A. Target adding 3 – 6 high quality sports fields over the next ten years, in alignment with community growth, including one new synthetic turf field.
- B. Increase functional ball diamond capacity through a combination of improvements to existing diamonds and the addition of 3 – 4 new Class A diamonds.
- C. Continue to explore site options to develop a new sports and recreation park in Abbotsford.
- D. Continue to engage with the cricket community to plan for the future of the sport in Abbotsford and associated infrastructure needs.

****The Draft Strategy identifies that the addition of high quality fields and diamonds to inventory could occur through a combination of new development and improvements to existing fields, diamonds, and support amenities.***

Draft Actions for Sport Courts

- A. Develop a comprehensive renewal plan for the sport court inventory.
- B. Use the recommended provision (service level) targets and approaches as a point of reference for future planning but validate and revisit on an ongoing basis.
- C. Remain open to non-traditional and creative solutions to meeting sport court demands.

****To support future planning, the Draft Strategy (Section 3.3.) identifies 10-year supply targets and provision approaches for the different types of courts available in the city.***

Draft Actions for Specialty Outdoor Sport Amenities

- A. Support the growth of disc golf.
- B. Work with impacted users and activity groups to determine future options based on the direction of the Mill Lake Park Master Plan.
- C. Sustain the existing skateboard parks.
- D. Identify opportunities to support the growth of bike sports in Abbotsford and align with other future planning direction.



Next Steps – So what happens next?

Feedback on the Draft Strategy will be collected until March 20th through targeted sessions with user groups and a public web feedback survey.

The feedback provided will be used to help refine and finalize the Strategy.

The final Sport Field & Sport Court Strategy will have an implementation plan that includes the following detail for each of the Actions:



Targeted timeframes and sequencing



Estimated resourcing requirements



Key site and technical considerations (where applicable)

It is important to note that outdoor sport amenities are one of many service areas that the City will need to consider investment in over the following decades. The guidance and recommendations provided by the Sport Field & Sport Court will need to be integrated into overall City budgeting and prioritized with other service area project and needs.

